Body image and media messages

Independent · Thursday 4 March 2027 · P4 · Year A

Body image, self-esteem & the media.

Core ideas

• Body image concerns thoughts and feelings about the body. People deserve respect whatever they look like. The class does not rate or compare bodies.

• An advert may try to sell an item by promising feelings or approval. Separate the item description from a promise and ask what evidence supports it.

• A post may show a selected view. In the supplied story, the source note shows omitted practice and help. One post cannot show a whole life; this does not make every post false.

• A body neutral rewrite describes the item or activity without judging looks. If a message causes worry or hurt, the invented learner can stop engaging and ask a trusted adult or the safeguarding lead for help.

The invented model

A plain text advert says: 'Buy this craft kit. Look perfect. Feel sure every day.' A note says: 'This advert sells a craft kit. It gives no evidence for its promise.' An invented learner sees the advert and begins to feel less sure about joining a club.

A visible reason

The message links buying a kit and looking a certain way with feeling sure. It gives no proof. A kit cannot promise how someone will feel each day. The learner's worth does not depend on looks or buying it. A fair rewrite is: 'This kit has craft materials. People can enjoy making things in different ways.' The learner could pause the advert and talk to a trusted adult.

Use the full cases in Support Cards. Reader and checker may swap, or work alone. Keep the glossary and usual aids. Use words, pointing, drawing, typing or the usual communication aid. An adult may scribe the learner's exact words and read them back. Plan in any language. Record access aids separately from prompts that supplied content.

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Independent book tasks

In your book or usual mode, use the fictional cases only. No personal stories are needed.

Task 1

Use the three invented cards. For case 1, separate an item fact from a sales promise. Explain the missing evidence. Write a fair advert line that gives item facts without linking looks or buying to worth.

Task 2

For case 2, explain how the source note changes the message. Write a caption that allows practice and help. State one limit of what a post can show.

Task 3

For case 3, choose a kind response and a safe help plan. Explain why the learner need not reply or forward the hurtful item. Give a second adult route if the first adult is unavailable.

Words and frame

Body image · Self-esteem · Media · Selected · Sales claim

The story shows ___. This matters because ___. The character could ___ and ask ___ for help.

Learning self check

In your book, choose Ready to explain, With a prompt or Need another example for each learning point. All choices start blank. This is a learning check, not a judgement about health, family life or safety. Pass is valid.

- Explain why a post cannot show a person's full life or worth.
- Spot a sales promise or a selected view in an invented message.
- Choose a kind response and a safe route to adult help.

Review and help

Keep the first try. Use one next step and reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A character can tell a trusted adult or the safeguarding lead privately. If the first adult is away or does not help, try another trusted adult. If there is danger now, get urgent help. No one needs to prove a worry before asking for help.

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